Casey D. Foley, PhD

Laser & Vacuum Systems | Ion & Electron Beams | Spectroscopy | Metrology & Process Development

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SUMMARY

Laser and vacuum systems expert and physical chemist with 12+ years across manufacturing, a national laboratory, and university research. Leads laser, vacuum, and metrology projects from idea to plant floor; results include 99% yield, 3× faster laser cycles, and a ~40% shorter vacuum process cycle.

CORE SKILLS

Lasers & Optics	Fiber, Nd:YAG/DPSS, CO_2, excimer, Ti:sapphire, dye, IR OPO/OPA, VUV; drilling, ablation, heating; beam diagnostics, Zemax, Class 4 laser safety
Vacuum & Beams	Production high vacuum, UHV design, 5K cryogenics, plasma discharges, kV ion optics (SIMION), molecular beams, MCP detectors, MeV electron diffraction, SolidWorks
Metrology & Vision	Deflectometry, confocal profilometry, line-scan vision, laser-based R-value measurement, GR&R, color measurement (CIELAB)
Spectroscopy	UV/Vis/IR, FTIR, REMPI, LIF, IR–UV double resonance, velocity-map imaging, IMS-MS
Process & Quality	Process development, FAT/SAT, commissioning, DOE, SPC, Cp/Cpk, PFMEA, 8D, control plans, SOPs, Lean/Six Sigma training
Software & Data	Python, JMP, LabVIEW, MATLAB; data acquisition, instrument control
Communication	15+ conference presentations, 23 peer-reviewed papers, cross-functional liaison, mentoring and training

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Staff Scientist — Apr 2026 – Present

Laser Systems Engineer — Aug 2024 – Mar 2026

LuxWall, Inc. — vacuum-insulated glass manufacturing

- **Technical Leadership:** Subject-matter expert for all laser and high vacuum processes and technical liaison between production, R&D, and scaling.
- **Laser Drilling:** Integrated a fiber laser through FAT and commissioning for a 3× faster cycle, and cut defects from ~1 in 10 parts to ≤1% with in-line confocal sensing and auto-focus.
- **Laser Ablation:** Doubled throughput of a second process at 99% yield with in-line confocal depth metrology, closed-loop focus, vision-based part location, and SPC; set its depth spec from first principles.
- **Evacuation:** Conceived a physics-based process change, validated it through gated trials (DOE, FMEA, difference-in-differences), and aligned every level of the company; ~40% shorter cycle.
- **R-Value Metrology:** Developed a proprietary laser-based thermal-performance measurement system from algorithm to plant floor, plus the protocol for using it in production quality screening.
- **Flatness Metrology:** Led development of a phase-shifting deflectometry system for in-line 100% inspection; wrote a Python pipeline for micron-level confocal profiling.
- **In-Line Inspection:** Wrote the spec, ran a competitive vendor selection, and led FAT/SAT of an in-line line-scan inspection system now measuring production parts and detecting defects; set its GR&R acceptance criteria and held the vendor to spec with tool-vs-manual correlation.
- **Process Capability:** Studied 14 QC characteristics (I–MR, Cp/Cpk), set control limits, revised spec limits, and quantified a ~70% variation cut from a sensor upgrade.
- **Root-Cause Analysis:** Eliminated drilling cracks using tens of thousands of production records (chi-square, random-forest importance), microscopy, and a new laser recipe.
- **Seal Quality:** Cut worst-rated seals from ~15% to ~3% with a new laser sealing recipe; wrote its reaction plan.
- **Capacity Planning:** Built a multi-line capacity simulator that engineering and management use to find throughput constraints and test improvements.

- **Laser Safety & Standards:** Defined Class 4 controls (ANSI Z136.1/.9, FDA 21 CFR 1040, NFPA 115) for the production lasers; own control plans, preventive maintenance, SOPs, and work instructions.

Research Excellence Postdoctoral Fellow Aug 2022 – Jul 2024
University of Missouri — Department of Chemistry

- **Plasma Beam Source:** Designed and built a fast-atom/ion beam machine around a pulsed plasma-discharge source, from new and repurposed hardware, to study hypersonic-flow chemistry.
- **Plasma Diagnostics:** Characterized discharge plasmas and their N^+, N_2^+, O^+, O_2^+, and Ar^+ beams for two years with MCP/phosphor imaging, cameras, and PMTs.
- **Ion Optics:** Designed and modeled the kilovolt beam line: Einzel and deceleration optics, a quadrupole energy filter, and a charge-exchange cell.
- **VUV & Ultrafast:** Built a 118 nm VUV light source (355 nm tripled in Xe/Ar); operated the instrument on shifts during MeV ultrafast electron diffraction experiments at SLAC and helped analyze the data in Python.
- **Lab Management:** As senior postdoc, managed the lab for four graduate students and three other postdocs.

Postdoctoral Associate Mar 2021 – Jul 2022
Sandia National Laboratories — Combustion Research Facility

- **Instrument Recovery:** Returned a relocated $1M+ cryogenic ion-trap mass spectrometer to full operation: restored its high vacuum system and 5K cold trap, calibrated tunable IR OPO/OPA and UV dye lasers, and rebuilt LabVIEW timing and scan control.
- **Spectroscopy:** Recorded IR and UV spectra of cryo-cooled ions by IR–UV double resonance, including time-resolved excited-state spectra; first-author *JACS* and *J. Phys. Chem. A* papers.

Graduate Research Assistant May 2016 – Dec 2020
University of Missouri — Suits Group

- ***Science* Paper:** First author on quantum resonances in formaldehyde, measured by velocity-map imaging.
- **Laser Automation:** Designed laser automation and custom optical detection for UHV molecular-beam experiments; built a REMPI-characterized radical source.

Graduate Research & Teaching Assistant Aug 2013 – Apr 2016
Wayne State University

- **Mass Spectrometry:** Developed ionization and ion-mobility mass spectrometry methods on Waters, Thermo, and Bruker platforms for biological and polymer analysis.
- **Lab Safety & SOPs:** Wrote the Synapt calibration SOP; laser-safety lead for the Class 3B UV laser.

EDUCATION

PhD, Physical Chemistry, University of Missouri Dec 2020
Dissertation: *Quantum Aspects of Roaming Dynamics* (Prof. Arthur G. Suits)

BS, Biochemistry, Saginaw Valley State University — Dow Chemical toxicology co-op (2010–2012) May 2013

Honors: Army Research Laboratory Journeyman Fellowship (2018) · WSU Thomas C. Rumble Fellowship (2014–2015) · WSU Chemistry Citation for Excellence in Teaching (2014) · SVSU President's Scholarship (2009–2013)

PUBLICATIONS & PRESENTATIONS

23 papers (8 first-author) and a 2026 preprint · 450+ citations · h-index 10 · cdfoley.com/publications

- **C. D. Foley** et al., "Site-specific photochemistry along a protonated peptide scaffold," *JACS* 146, 13282 (2024).
- **C. D. Foley** et al., "Molecular cage reports on its contents: spectroscopic signatures of cryo-cooled K^+- and Ba^{2+}-benzocryptand complexes," *J. Phys. Chem. A* 127, 6227 (2023).
- **C. D. Foley**, C. Xie, H. Guo, A. G. Suits, "Orbiting resonances in formaldehyde reveal coupling of roaming, radical, and molecular channels," *Science* 374, 1122 (2021).
- **C. D. Foley** et al., "Use of ion mobility spectrometry–mass spectrometry to elucidate architectural dispersity within star polymers," *ACS Macro Lett.* 4, 778 (2015).

Presentations (15+): Dynamics of Molecular Collisions Conference (2017, 2019, 2023), International Symposium on Molecular Spectroscopy (2022), ASMS Conference on Mass Spectrometry (2014, 2015), Army Research Laboratory Symposium (2018), ACS National Meeting (2013), and ARO and MURI program reviews.